Roman Key Card Blackwood - 1430 version

RKCB is similar to Blackwood, but instead of four Aces there are Five Keycards. They are the Aces plus the King of the agreed trump suit. Starting with 4NT, a reply of 5♣ shows 1 or 4 Keycards, 5♦ shows 0 or 3, 5♥ shows 2 Keycards but no trump Queen, and 5♠ shows 2 Keycards with the trump Queen.
If your side has all five Keycards, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings, remembering that there are only three Kings since the trump King is counted as a Keycard. There are two popular methods for responding to 5NT. The first is the same as normal Blackwood - 6♣ shows no Kings, 6♦ shows one, and 6♥ shows three. This is the method used in the recommended bidding here.
If the response to 4NT is 5♣ or 5♦ the 4NT bidder may choose to ask about the trump Queen rather than ask for Kings. She does this by bidding the cheapest non-trump suit. Partner denies the trump Queen by returning to the trump suit. A 5NT bid confirms the trump Queen, but shows no outside Kings. Bidding any non-trump suit confirms the trump Queen and also the King of the suit bid.
Void showing by Responder is handled just as in regular Blackwood except it refers to one or two Keycards, rather than one or two Aces.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠9

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♣K

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 6♠
Declarer: South
Lead: ♦J

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 5♠
Declarer: West
Lead: ♦2

Board: 5
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 3NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♦Q

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ A J 6 ♥ K 7 5 ♦ K Q 5 3 ♣ A J 5	
♠ 10 4 3 2 ♥ J 4 3 ♦ A 10 9 ♣ 8 4 2		♠ 9 8 7 ♥ 10 8 2 ♦ J 8 2 ♣ Q 10 7 3
	♠ K Q 5 ♥ A Q 9 6 ♦ 7 6 4 ♣ K 9 6	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♦	Pass	1♥
Pass	2NT	Pass	4NT
All Pass			

4NT by North
Lead: ♠9

What is this doing here in the RKCB Practice Pages?

To emphasize that there are many 4NT bids which are NOT asking for Aces.

In this case, NORTH showed a balanced hand with 18 or 19 points, and SOUTH invited him to bid 6NT if he felt his hand was a "maximum". He didn't, so he passed.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ J 10 4 3 ♥ 10 4 ♦ A 6 ♣ Q J 9 5 3	
♠ A 9 7 2 ♥ Q J 5 3 ♦ Q J 7 5 3 ♣ —		♠ K 5 ♥ A K 9 7 6 2 ♦ K 8 ♣ 7 6 4
	♠ Q 8 6 ♥ 8 ♦ 10 9 4 2 ♣ A K 10 8 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♥	Pass
4♣	Pass	4NT	Pass
6♣	Pass	6♥	
All Pass			

6♥ by East
Lead: ♣K

When WEST makes a Splinter bid, showing ♥ support and ♣ shortness, EAST naturally thinks about slam.

She uses RKCB 4NT, and WEST, with one Key Card and a ♣ Void, bids 6♣.

Just what EAST needed for the 6♥ bid.

Board 3
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ A K 6 3 ♥ K Q 10 4 ♦ K Q 8 5 ♣ 2	
♠ 7 4 ♥ J 8 2 ♦ J 10 9 7 ♣ A 7 5 4		♠ J 10 5 ♥ 7 6 3 ♦ 3 2 ♣ 10 9 8 6 3
	♠ Q 9 8 2 ♥ A 9 5 ♦ A 6 4 ♣ K Q J	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♠[2]
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards with the trump queen

6♠ by South
Lead: ♦J

NORTH thinks they should be in slam, and uses Stayman to check for a 4-4 Major fit.

When SOUTH announces four ♠s NORTH uses RKCB 4NT.

SOUTH's 5♠ bid shows two Key Cards plus the ♠Q.

This fills the holes in NORTH's hand nicely, so she bids 6♠.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 10 7 5 ♥ J 2 ♦ 9 6 2 ♣ A 10 9 7 3	
♠ J 9 8 2 ♥ A 9 5 ♦ A J 4 ♣ K Q J		♠ A K 6 3 ♥ K Q 10 4 ♦ K Q 8 5 ♣ 2
	♠ Q 4 ♥ 8 7 6 3 ♦ 10 7 3 ♣ 8 6 5 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1NT	Pass	2♣	Pass
2♠	Pass	4NT[1]	Pass
5♥[2]	Pass	5♠	
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards without the trump queen

5♠ by West
Lead: ♦2

This is the companion hand to Deal 18.

Again, EAST uses RKCB after the 4-4 ♠ fit is discovered. This time WEST shows two Key Cards without the ♠Q.

Now EAST realizes that in addition to one outside Ace, there is a very possible loser in trumps. So she stops at 5♠.

Board 5
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ A K 4 ♥ J 9 5 ♦ A K 7 6 ♣ A 5 4	
♠ Q 10 8 ♥ 3 2 ♦ 10 4 2 ♣ Q J 9 6 2		♠ J 9 6 5 ♥ 10 7 ♦ Q J 9 8 ♣ K 10 3
	♠ 7 3 2 ♥ A K Q 8 6 4 ♦ 5 3 ♣ 8 7	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♥
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by North
Lead: ♦Q

The chances of a slam on this hand are very small, and if NORTH decides to use RKCB it will just confuse matters when SOUTH shows two Key Cards.

NORTH has a better way to find out about the hand. She bids 2NT asking SOUTH to further describe his hand. SOUTH should then bid 3NT, showing a solid suit headed by AKQ.

SOUTH cannot have as much as an extra Jack, so NORTH just passes 3NT.